
CURSO DE LECTURA COMPRENSIVA DE TEXTOS EN INGLÉS
PROGRAMA DE IDIOMA INGLÉS - UNIVERSIDAD NACIONAL DEL SUR
NIVEL II – Modelo TP 2

Apellido y nombre:

L.U.:

Comisión:

Carrera:

From 1950 to 1980, the so-called “Green Revolution” swept the world. World food production doubled with the introduction of a new approach to agriculture. It involved the large-scale cultivation of new types of grain (wheat, corn, and rice), and the extensive use of chemicals and farm machinery.

These features were the **cause** of the early, enormous success of this “revolution.” However, the “Green Revolution” methods no longer appear to be successful. Though the population continues to grow, food production has failed to keep up with it.

There are a number of reasons for this. **One reason** lies in the expense of the new farming methods. The new kinds of grain **produce** much more than traditional grains, but only under certain conditions. In order to get maximum production, farmers must use large amounts of expensive chemical fertilizers. They also need to use expensive chemical insecticides since the new grains are more easily damaged by insects. Expensive watering systems are also necessary for these grains, especially in drier areas. Many farmers cannot afford to buy all the chemicals and equipment.

Erosion is **another reason** for the lower grain production. The large-scale farming of a single crop **creates the perfect conditions for** erosion. In dry areas, especially the loss of top soil has lowered the productivity of the land. In these areas, also, grain production has been limited by the lack of water. The new types of grain, in fact, require much more water than the grains people used to grow.

Yet another reason for lower production lies in the nature of the chemicals that farmers have used. Though these fertilizers and pesticides raise production levels at first, they must be used in increasing amounts after that. Many farmers cannot afford to buy more, and **so** production decreases. These chemicals have other **effects** that are expensive in the long run. They flow into the ground water, **causing** pollution and health problems. As people learn about these problems, they put pressure on farmers to further limit their use of chemicals.

Finally, the Green Revolution **has brought about** social and political conflict that has interfered with food production. The problem lies in the cost of the new agricultural methods. Only the larger landowners can afford to make the necessary investments for maximum production of the new grains. With their profits, the large landowners then buy land from the smaller farmers. This way, the large landowners **become** even richer and the number of landless poor people increases. Social tensions naturally increase this situation.

Clearly, it is time to question the methods of the Green Revolution. Governments and farmers need to look at the overall picture and **long-term effects**. They need to find new methods that will better meet the needs of the world’s hungry people and will also be less destructive.

1. Después de realizar una primera lectura, indicar si las siguientes oraciones son verdaderas o falsas, en el caso de las falsas redactar la versión verdadera (se evaluarán ambas actividades: indicar V/F y corrección).

a. El texto describe los aspectos positivos de la Revolución Verde.

(F) Describe también los aspectos negativos.

b. La Revolución Verde consistió en el cultivo de nuevos tipos de granos y en el uso de agroquímicos y maquinarias. **(V)**

- c. La producción de alimentos en todo el mundo ha disminuido mientras la población sigue creciendo. (V)
- d. El cultivo de un único tipo de grano a gran escala genera erosión. (V)
- e. Los nuevos tipos de granos requieren menos agua que los granos tradicionales.
(F) Requieren mucha más agua.

2. Leer detenidamente los párrafos 3 a 6 e indicar a cuál de ellos pertenecen las siguientes ideas principales. Hay una idea extra.

- 4 a. La erosión genera una disminución en la producción de granos.
- 6 b. Los nuevos métodos de cultivo han aumentado las diferencias entre ricos y pobres.
- 3 c. Cultivar los nuevos tipos de granos resulta más costoso que el cultivo de los granos tradicionales.
- d. La producción mundial de alimentos se duplicó con la introducción de los métodos de la Revolución Verde.
- 5 e. Los fertilizantes y pesticidas son caros y peligrosos para el medioambiente.

3. En el texto predominan dos patrones de organización. Indicar cuáles son y transcribir tres señales (palabras o frases) para cada patrón:

Patrón 1: Causa/efecto

Señales: 1. cause
2. reasons
3. effects

Patrón 2: Listado de ideas relacionadas

Señales: 1. One reason
2. another reason
3. Finally

4. Señalar la opción que mejor expresa la idea principal de todo el texto y a continuación expresarla en español.

- a. Traditional farming methods were preferred by the large landowners.
- b. The Green Revolution methods are often unproductive and destructive.
- c. Both traditional farming methods and the Green revolution methods have the same effect on the environment.
- d. The new types of grain are easier to cultivate than the traditional kinds.

Idea principal (en español): Los métodos de la revolución verde a menudo son improductivos y destructivos.

5. Proponer un título en español para el texto.

La Revolución Verde

Los efectos (negativos) de la Revolución Verde

Consecuencias de la Revolución Verde